“Are you all right?”

“I’ll be fine. Take care of yourself, Rose.”

She yearned to pull him close, feel his warmth, kiss him. Yet, she restrained herself, fists tightly balled, knuckles white. “You should go now,” she said, her voice trembling, holding back tears. If she could survive this moment, she could survive anything.

“I’m going.”

Closing her eyes, she went back in time to when she’d asked Maître Mallon to write to André. It felt like a whole lifetime had passed since then. Now, listening to his footsteps on the wooden floor moving away from her, she wished for him to live a long and happy life and to find someone deserving of him to share it with. Rose had made her pact with Reinhardt, and for her, there was no turning back.